

TKT-2026-0903-336 - Customers refunded twice on 640 orders

Support Ticket | Support

Document ID	TKT-2026-0903-336	Seller ID	S003
Department	Support	Classification	CONFIDENTIAL
Owner	Rahul Sharma	Created Date	2026-09-03
Related Scenario ID	SC-007	Document Type	Support Ticket

Ticket Header

Field	Value
Ticket ID	TKT-2026-0903-336
Seller	S003 - GreenCart Organics
Raised by	Ananya Rao
Channel	Seller portal, followed by phone
Raised at	2026-09-03 17:20 IST
Priority	P1 - Critical (financial, seller cash exposure)
Category	Refunds and payments
Assigned to	Rahul Sharma, Support
Escalated to	Vikram Singh (Engineering), Neha Gupta (Operations)
Closed at	2026-09-11 13:00 IST
Final status	Resolved - duplicates reversed, idempotency control added

Report

Ananya reported that her payment reconciliation showed refund amounts roughly double the expected value for 2 and 3 September. She had checked a sample of twelve orders manually and found two refund transactions against each.

Her concern was immediate and specific: GreenCart is a small business, the excess had already left the platform's payment rails, and any recovery would come out of her settlement. She asked directly whether the platform intended to recover the money from her in a single deduction.

Scope Confirmed

Check	Result
Orders with two refund transactions	640
Refund event count in the period	1,280 for 640 unique refunds
Excess refunded	INR 1,18,000
Time window	2 September 21:15 to 3 September 02:40 IST

Check	Result
Other sellers affected	3 orders on other accounts in the same window

The near-exclusive concentration on S003 was the first thing I checked and the first thing I reported. It was not because the defect was account-specific. It was because GreenCart's refund-on-report category exception means this account generates far more refund events per order than any other seller, so a defect in refund processing surfaces here first.

Escalation

Escalated to Engineering at 17:48 IST. The pattern - exactly two applications of the same refund, within a narrow window, concentrated on the account with the highest refund event volume - pointed at event redelivery rather than at a calculation error, and I said so in the escalation note.

Operations was included because any recovery from a seller settlement needs an operations decision, not a support decision.

Cause

The refund webhook consumer restarted during a deployment at 21:12 on 2 September. The broker redelivered events that had been processed but not acknowledged. The consumer applied refunds without checking an idempotency key, so each redelivered event produced a second refund.

Detail is in INC-2026-0903.

The Recovery Question

This was the substance of the ticket, more than the technical cause.

Operations decided that the excess INR 1,18,000 would be recovered across four settlement cycles rather than in a single deduction, and that no interest or fee would apply. The reasoning was that the seller did not cause the error and a single large debit on a cash-constrained account would have caused real operational harm for no benefit to the platform.

Customers who received a duplicate refund were not asked to return it. The duplicated amounts were reversed at the payment-processor level where the transaction had not yet settled, which covered 412 of the 640 cases. For the remaining 228, the amount was written off rather than pursued, on cost and proportionality grounds.

Timeline

Date and time (IST)	Event
02 Sep 21:12	Refund consumer restarts during deployment
02 Sep 21:15	First duplicate refunds applied
03 Sep 02:40	Last duplicate refund applied
03 Sep 17:20	Seller raises ticket after reconciliation
03 Sep 17:48	Escalated to Engineering and Operations
03 Sep 20:10	Event redelivery confirmed as cause
04 Sep 11:00	Seller call, recovery approach agreed
04 Sep 16:30	Idempotency store deployed
05 Sep 14:00	412 duplicate transactions reversed

Date and time (IST)	Event
08 Sep 10:00	228 residual cases written off
10 Sep 09:00	Refund duplication alert configured
11 Sep 13:00	Ticket closed

Resolution

An idempotency store keyed on refund event identifier was deployed on 4 September with a 30-day retention window. Duplicate refunds were reversed where possible and written off where not. A duplication alert on refund volume per account was configured on 10 September. Refund idempotency is required by the Payment and Settlement Policy (POL-FIN-002), and the staged recovery follows the Payment Recovery Runbook (OPS-RB-004).

Recovery of the INR 1,18,000 excess is staged across four settlement cycles beginning 15 September 2026.

Support Observation

The requirement to handle at-least-once delivery is written into the S002 integration specification and was designed into the S001 order webhook receiver in 2023. The refund consumer predates both and was never revisited. This was a known platform characteristic that one component had not been checked against.